COFOUNDER PITCH · TANNER WOODRUM · 2026-04-25

# TWO BUILDERS. THREE ENTITIES. THREE LANES. ONE MISSION.

*Garage startup execution. Federal pipeline activated. Joint engine ready.*

Michael Cochran · Founder · The Cochran Block, LLC · cochranblock.org

10-slide Kawasaki format · supplementary appendix below · structural credit: guykawasaki.com

SLIDE 01 · OF 10 · MISSION

## AI Integrity Before Bad Outcomes Lock In.

**Civilizational stakes.**
**Garage startup execution.**

- AI deployed faster than anyone can verify
- Federal-grade integrity layer needs to exist BEFORE the next preventable incident
- Hardware-signed cert protocols + AI-piloted authorship at production scale
- Two cofounders, $364 cumulative spend, 60+ days, working substrate

# Four gaps. All overlapping.

- AI models deployed without verifiable integrity - **no hardware root of trust**
- Federal procurement of AI capability is glacial; **ansible-tier tooling makes it slower**
- Audience-builders can't reach substrate-tier; substrate-builders can't reach audiences
- Consumer app market dominated by ad-supported and microtransaction-driven extraction

**Each founder type alone hits a ceiling. Together they don't.**

# Two builders, three entities, three lanes, one mission.

- **Michael:** Title 10 OCO @ ARCYBER 103 CMT. Substrate, federal, methodology, SkillBridge network
- **Tanner:** Ghostcoded founder. Audience, brand, commercial automation, consumer apps
- AI-piloted authorship loop running across all lanes
- Three-entity structure: GovCo (federal) + Ghostcoded (consumer apps + content) + JointCo (joint AI-commercial engine)

*"Vacuum coding is how you get to space." Way faster together.*

# The window. Federal pipeline activated. Talent pipeline accessible. AI accelerating past integrity.

- **ARCYBER interest active** (former-unit network reactivation)
- **SOCOM scout card submitted:** $195K AI Edge, TRL 5
- NDAA Section 1513 + Section 868 OTAs creating procurement pull
- **SkillBridge talent pipeline accessible** - Title 10 OCO / 103 CMT / ARCYBER veterans, zero-cost 180-day intakes
- Speedrun cohort timing perfect for parallel commercial + federal pursuit
- Ansible-tier baseline ripe for displacement on government systems
- Consumer app market increasingly hostile to users - opening for ethical-positioning entrant
- **Cloud repatriation thesis going mainstream** - 37signals saved $2M/yr; DHH's "leaving the cloud"; Cloudflare Tunnel collapses the geographic-distribution moat at $0/mo

> **Federal vocabulary glossary** (used once, then assumed across the deck):
> **SDVOSB** - Service-Disabled Veteran-Owned Small Business; federal procurement set-aside category requiring ≥51% unconditional veteran ownership.
> **TRL 5** - Technology Readiness Level 5 (component validation in relevant environment, on a 1–9 DoD scale).
> **ARCYBER 103 CMT** - Army Cyber Command, 103rd Cyber Mission Team - operational offensive cyber unit.
> **SkillBridge** - DoD program; transitioning service members do civilian work experience while still on military pay (zero

cost to host company for 180 days).

**Section 1513 / Section 868 OTAs** - NDAA provisions enabling AI integrity standards + rapid-prototype federal procurement vehicles.

**AI Edge** - federal capability category for AI running on tactical/edge devices in disconnected environments (no cloud required).

# Three revenue logics. One capability stack.

| LANE | ENTITY | CUSTOMER | ECONOMICS |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Federal** | Cochran Block (GovCo) | DoD, intel, banking | High-margin · slow-cycle · regulated |
| **Commercial AI** | JointCo | HF / Civitai / Ollama publishers, insurance, compliance | Medium-margin · fast-cycle · B2B |
| **Consumer apps** | Ghostcoded | Indie / privacy-conscious / builder-community | Ethical positioning · no ads · no microtransactions · direct-to-audience |

**Operator guild:** SkillBridge intakes + post-conversion W-2 hires from former-unit network.

# 60 days. $364. 22 products. ~1,598 tests. TRL 5. Federal pipeline activated.

- **Substrate stack:** 22+ Rust repos · 5-gate audit pipeline · IRONHIVE distributed cluster · ESP32 hardware root of trust (KNOXAI signing)
- **Federal lane active:** SOCOM AI Edge submission ($195K, TRL 5) · ARCYBER interest (Title 10 OCO + 103 CMT) · SDVOSB pending (CAGE 1CQ66 / UEI W7X3HAQL9CF9)
- **Audience asset:** Ghostcoded - 4K LinkedIn, 74 paid Skool, $100K LinkedIn-inbound in 7mo
- **Talent pipeline:** SkillBridge cleared-vet intakes via former-unit network (zero-cost 180-day intakes, W-2 conversion path)
- **Team formed:** Operator #1 (Earl Harris) signed · Chief Advisor (John Szeder) onboarded

**~11–22x** typical solo founder velocity · **137–1,370x** typical capital efficiency · **8–32x** typical test density at higher TRL.

# Asymmetric by design. Substrate-tier + audience-tier, one shared cognitive operating system.

| MICHAEL BRINGS | TANNER BRINGS |
|---|---|
| Substrate (kova, exopack, IRONHIVE, KNOXAI) | Audience (4K LinkedIn, 74 paid Skool, $100K inbound/7mo) |
| Federal credentialing (Title 10 OCO, ARCYBER, SDVOSB) | Brand instinct + commercial-content velocity |
| Methodology systematization (AI-piloted authorship) | Frontend register + distribution architecture |
| SkillBridge access + dual-use articulation | n8n / AI-agency / indie-builder community fluency |

**Cognitive match:** cluster-thinking, ADHD-concurrency, gamification instinct, witty-metaphor teachers.

**Convergent design:** independently arrived at tournament framing (micro tournament + Clone Wars Battle).

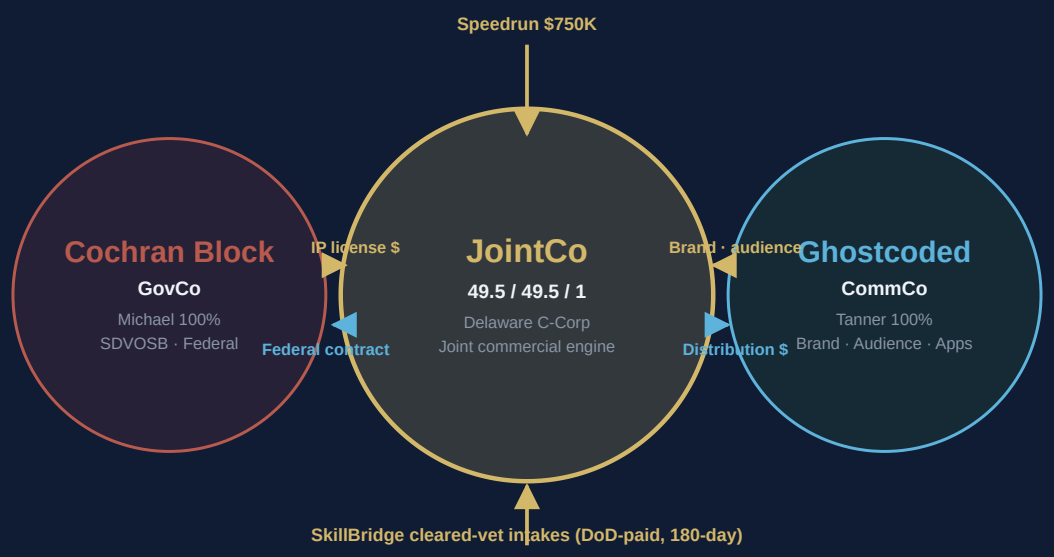
*"Vacuum coding is how you get to space."* Way faster together.

# You keep yours. I keep mine. We build JointCo together.

- **Tanner keeps Ghostcoded 100%** - brand, audience, products all stay yours
- **Michael keeps Cochran Block (GovCo) 100%** - SDVOSB, federal lane
- **JointCo built together** - 49.5 / 49.5 / 1 (Michael / Tanner / John advisor tie-breaker)
- Conversion option to 33.3 / 33.3 / 33.4 if John commits to full third-cofounder role within 12 months
- Federal revenue routes from GovCo to JointCo via fair-market IP licensing (30–50% of contract value)
- Ghostcoded brand stays your face; Cochran Block stays my federal vehicle

**No fold-in. No equity dilution of existing businesses. Full upside on shared work.**

# Three entities. Three logics. JointCo is the engine.




| ENTITY | OWNERSHIP | ROLE |
|---|---|---|
| **Cochran Block (GovCo)** | Michael 100% | SDVOSB-pending · federal contracts · self-funding · doesn't pay Michael personally beyond tax distributions |
| **Ghostcoded (CommCo)** | Tanner 100% | Existing brand and audience untouched · hosts consumer-app lane |
| **JointCo** | 49.5 / 49.5 / 1 | Delaware C-Corp · takes Speedrun investment · joint products · hosts SkillBridge talent pipeline |

All three entities operate under **joint-decision discipline** on cross-business strategic moves. Full mechanics + cash flow + math in appendix below.

> **Open books.** All Rights Reserved by default. Unlicense-equivalent grant when code on government systems. Cross-flow GovCo → JointCo via fair-market IP licensing (30–50% of contract value). Capability transfer between entities by joint cofounder decision. Nothing hidden.

# Say yes. We build this week.

- Yes to cofounder partnership under three-entity structure
- **Schedule working session this week.** Stage Zero options on the table: cloud-stack repatriation prototype (Cloud Cost Assassin in action), n8n→Rust compiler MVP (productize what we just learned), or whichever JointCo product your audience wants first
- 2–3 week onboarding: Rust + WASM + AI-piloted authorship loop
- Joint pitch to Speedrun for parallel commercial + federal capital
- 18 months of runway (way more time than we actually need)

*"Vacuum coding is how you get to space."* Said in vacuum, way cleaner together.

> **Two cofounders. $750K. 18 months runway. Multi-entity speedrun.** Calculated railgun, not David-vs-Goliath. Iron Man cave methodology. "*I do it. Then I do it again.*"

APPENDIX · OPEN BOOKS

# THE MECHANICS, CASH FLOW, AND MATH

*Everything in the deck, with the operational depth underneath. Transparent by default.*

APPENDIX A · MECHANICS

## How money and IP actually flow

- **IP policy:** All Rights Reserved by default; Unlicense-equivalent grant when code on government systems
- **Cross-flow GovCo → JointCo:** GovCo licenses IP from JointCo at fair-market rates (30–50% of contract value) for federal contract delivery
- **Cross-flow JointCo → Ghostcoded:** JointCo licenses Ghostcoded brand/audience for joint commercial product distribution at fair-market rates
- **Free starter kit Michael → Ghostcoded:** Michael's existing consumer products (wowasticker, pocket-server, call-shield, pixel-forge, whyyoulying, illbethejudgeofthat) transfer to Ghostcoded via perpetual royalty-free exclusive license - Tanner gets working portfolio to grow Ghostcoded with from day one, no charge
- **SkillBridge pipeline:** JointCo registers as DoD SkillBridge provider, receives zero-cost cleared-vet labor for 180 days per intake, W-2 conversion path to JointCo (commercial) or GovCo (federal) post-SkillBridge
- **Capability transfer between entities by joint cofounder decision** - All Rights Reserved → Unlicense flip on federal delivery requires both founders' signatures

APPENDIX B · CASH FLOW

## Who draws from where, how much, when

| SOURCE | MICHAEL | TANNER | JOHN |
|---|---|---|---|
| Speedrun investment ($750K) | Lands in JointCo | Lands in JointCo | - |
| JointCo W-2 salary | Yes (49.5%) | Yes (49.5%) | - |
| JointCo distributions | 50% of distributable | 50% of distributable | 1% pro-rata |
| GovCo income | Tax distributions only (cover K-1) | - | - |
| Ghostcoded distributions | - | 100% | - |
| Advisor retainer (49.5/49.5/1 default) | - | - | $10K/qtr + $250–400/hr |
| Conversion to 33.3/33.3/33.4 | Dilution to 33.3% | Dilution to 33.3% | Full cofounder W-2 + 33.4% |

**GovCo retains all federal contract revenue** post-tax-distributions for federal capability scaling, future contract bids, war chest. Michael's personal income flows from JointCo + Speedrun cofounder cash; Tanner's flows from JointCo + Ghostcoded.

## 3.5x base rate × 5x payout ceiling = 17x expected-value advantage over typical pre-seed

**Standard pre-seed:** 10–15% success rate, $10–50M payout potential, $1–5M expected founder outcome.

**This team's verifiable inputs:**

- **Michael velocity:** 22 products / 60 days = 11–22x typical solo velocity
- **Capital efficiency:** $364 spent = 137–1,370x typical capital efficiency
- **Test density:** ~1,598 tests at TRL 5 = 8–32x typical density at higher tier
- **Tanner audience:** 4K LinkedIn + 74 paid Skool + $100K/7mo inbound = $200–500K + 2–4 years to replicate from scratch
- **John credentials:** Zynga IPO + multi-time 0→1 + patents + expert witness = structurally under-priced strategic asset at 1% + retainer

**Compounded probability:** ~35–50% likelihood of meaningful outcome (vs 15% baseline). 2–3x typical pre-seed success rate.

**Payout ceiling:** $100M – $3B enterprise value across three lanes (federal lifetime $5–50M via SBIR ladder + commercial AI $10–100M via audience-led GTM + consumer apps $1–10M aggregate).

**Expected value:** $35M – $1.5B = 7–30x typical pre-seed expected value.

> **Iron Man framing:** Built the suit in a cave with $364 of scraps. Methodology is the moat. "*I do it. Then I do it again.*"
>
> **Railgun framing:** Properly calibrated structure + high operator skill + right target selection = one-shot heavy targets (federal contracts, commercial AI deals, consumer app market disruption). Not aimed at hoping to get lucky against a Goliath.

**Cloud repatriation scaling math:** at typical traffic profiles, sovereign cluster + Cloudflare Tunnel delivers same edge distribution + DDoS + analytics + HTTPS at ~$50/mo flat vs $300–5,000/mo cloud. Cost-per-traffic curve collapses to flat - not just cost-per-compute. ~250–1,000x throughput-per-dollar advantage at scale; ~30–100x lower memory footprint per equivalent function.

**Honest caveat:** probability multipliers are illustrative, not statistically validated. Federal lane gated by procurement timing. Cofounder relationships fail at industry-typical rates regardless of input quality. 18-month runway buffer assumes no major black swan.

APPENDIX D · DUAL-USE PORTFOLIO

## Everything is dual-use if you believe hard enough - and the credentialing makes it credible

| PRODUCT | COMMERCIAL (GHOSTCODED) | DUAL-USE FEDERAL ANGLE |
|---|---|---|
| wowasticker | Offline sticker chart for educators | Offline reward tracking for cleared facilities (no digital systems) |
| pocket-server | Your website lives on your phone | Tactical comms / disconnected operations / DDIL environments |
| call-shield | On-device call screening, no cloud | Operational security / counter-surveillance / SCIF-adjacent privacy |
| pixel-forge | Indie game asset generation, local-first | Synthetic data for training imagery / red-team adversarial examples |
| whyyoulying | Confrontational deception detection | Automated deception-detection toolkit (operationally relevant) |
| illbethejudgeofthat | Evaluation/scoring framework | Red-team / blue-team exercise scoring |

**Title 10 OCO + 103 CMT credentialing** is what makes the dual-use framing credible. A consumer-only founder could write the same words; evaluators wouldn't

trust them. Michael writes them and the evaluators trust them because of who's saying it.

End of pitch · End of appendix · cochranblock.org · /52-days · /constitution · github.com/cochranblock

Deck structure: Guy Kawasaki, "*The Only 10 Slides You Need in Your Pitch*"
Scope discipline: John Szeder, "*The Quadrangle of Software Shippiness*" · mofactor.com

Built in a vacuum. Way cleaner together.